Equality Media + Marketing

Independent media and marketing agency, Richmond, Melbourne VIC

$13M	Annual revenue, Smart50 rank 24	*SmartCompany Smart50 2025*
49%	Three year average revenue growth	*SmartCompany Smart50 2025*
30	People on the Richmond team	*AFR BOSS coverage, 2025*
2018	Year founded by Marilla Akkermans	*Company and press records*
#1	Best Place to Work in Media, 2025	*AdNews, April 2025*
$250K	Donated to Women's Property Initiatives	*B&T, April 2025*

KEY COMMERCIAL SIGNALS

- Team grew from 15 to 30 across 2024 to 25 while the studio footprint expanded (Smart50; AdNews)
- Named number one AFR BOSS Best Place to Work in Media, third year running (AdNews, April 2025)
- Runs a four day, full pay 32 hour week with 19 extra leave days across the team (B&T, 2025)
- Donates 10 percent of annual profit to Women's Property Initiatives, $250,000 in 2025 (B&T)
- Won the BIODERMA ANZ media account, full funnel strategy and channel remit (AdNews, March 2026)
- Great Place to Work certified, single studio location in Richmond VIC (Great Place to Work AU)

Equality Media + Marketing: Three commercial observations from ProfitPulse

01

Growth has outpaced the finance rhythm

The team has roughly doubled in the past year, from 15 to 30 people, while the studio kept its four day week at full pay and an expanded leave framework in place. Payroll now moves ahead of revenue recognition on retainer and campaign work, and without a rolling forecast the exact week that gap bites is hard to see in advance.

02

Self funded growth raises the stakes on cash timing

No funding round or facility has been publicly reported alongside this expansion, which points to growth funded from trading cash flow. That is a strong result, but it also means every hire and every new client onboarding draws on the same pool of cash the business needs for its own payroll and commitments.

03

The culture commitments are a genuine cost line

The four day week, the extended leave framework, and the $250,000 given to Women's Property Initiatives in 2025 are a deliberate cost structure, not an incidental one. Protecting it through further growth depends on knowing, week by week, what the business can actually afford to commit.

These are observations offered in good faith. The agency has built a workplace people want to be part of. The question is simply whether the cash rhythm keeps pace with the growth and the culture it is funding.

13 Week Cash Flow Build

$2,650 one off

A rolling 13 week cash flow forecast with three scenarios, so payroll timing is planned, not guessed, while the team keeps growing.

Step one: answer a few quick questions

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NITESH ROOPA

CA, Managing Partner, ProfitPulse

- 16 years across 4 countries
- 52 deals executed and managed
- Largest single deal, USD 1.3 billion, Cahora Bassa
- Total GRBT project value over AUD 10 billion

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